

Psalm 112

Blessed Is the Man That Feareth the Lord

Blessed is the man that feareth the Lord, that delighteth greatly in his commandments

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 Praise ye the LORD. Blessed is the man that feareth the LORD, that delighteth greatly in his commandments.
- 2 His seed shall be mighty upon earth: the generation of the upright shall be blessed.
- 3 Wealth and riches shall be in his house: and his righteousness endureth for ever.
- 4 Unto the upright there ariseth light in the darkness: he is gracious, and full of compassion, and righteous.
- 5 A good man sheweth favour, and lendeth: he will guide his affairs with discretion.
- 6 Surely he shall not be moved for ever: the righteous shall be in everlasting remembrance.
- 7 He shall not be afraid of evil tidings: his heart is fixed, trusting in the LORD.
- 8 His heart is established, he shall not be afraid, until he see his desire upon his enemies.
- 9 He hath dispersed, he hath given to the poor; his righteousness endureth for ever; his horn shall be exalted with honour.
- 10 The wicked shall see it, and be grieved; he shall gnash with his teeth, and melt away: the desire of the wicked shall perish.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 112 answers Psalm 111 verse for structure, an alphabetic acrostic portrait of the person shaped by fearing the Lord, mirroring language used of God Himself in the previous psalm (graciousness, compassion, righteousness enduring forever) back onto the one who trusts Him. Henry reads this deliberate echo as the psalm's central claim: those who fear the Lord actually come to resemble Him in character. MacArthur-style notes caution that the material blessings described are covenantal patterns, not guarantees, and that the psalm's real center of gravity is the fixed, fearless heart of verses 7–8.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

The psalm opens exactly where Psalm 111 closed: blessed is the one who fears the Lord and delights greatly in His commandments—delight, not mere duty, marking genuine reverence. That person's descendants are pictured as mighty on earth, the generation of the upright blessed in turn.

Verse 3-4

Wealth and riches are pictured in his house, his righteousness enduring forever, and light arising for the upright even in darkness—the same graciousness and compassion attributed to God in Psalm 111 now describing the person who fears Him. Character, not merely fortune, is the real inheritance being described.

Verse 5-6

A good man is described showing favor and lending generously, guiding his affairs with discretion; surely, the psalm insists, he will not be shaken, and the righteous will be remembered forever. Practical generosity and stability are named together, not as separate virtues.

Verse 7-8

The psalm's emotional center: he will not be afraid of evil tidings, his heart fixed, trusting in the Lord; his heart is established, unafraid, until he sees his desire upon his enemies. Fearlessness here is not naive but is rooted specifically in a settled trust that has already been tested.

Verse 9-10

He has dispersed generously, given to the poor, his righteousness enduring forever, his position exalted with honor. The wicked, by contrast, see this and are grieved, gnashing their teeth as their own desire perishes—the same root (fear or lack of it) producing two entirely different outcomes.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Fearing the Lord is not primarily a private feeling but a pattern of life—generous, discreet, stable, unafraid of bad news—because it rests on a heart genuinely fixed and trusting rather than on circumstances happening to be favorable. The psalm deliberately

mirrors God's own described character back onto the person who fears Him, suggesting that reverence for God is meant to be formative, not merely emotional.

Application for life today.

Examine whether your own obedience to God looks more like delight (v. 1) or mere duty, and ask what would need to change for commandments to feel less like obligation. Notice verse 7's specific promise—not fearing evil tidings—and identify what 'evil tidings' currently unsettle your heart, bringing that fear honestly before God rather than managing it alone. Practice the generosity described in verses 5 and 9 concretely this week, treating it as evidence of a fixed heart rather than a separate virtue from trust.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Does your relationship to God's commandments currently look more like delight (v. 1) or obligation, and what would move it closer to the former?

2. What specific 'evil tidings' (v. 7) are you currently afraid of, and what would it look like to bring that fear to God rather than manage it privately?

3. How might practicing the generosity described in verses 5 and 9 this week actually be evidence of, and not separate from, a genuinely fixed and trusting heart?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).